



#3593

THE CONQUEST OF THE INCAS

Grade Levels: 8-13+

30 minutes

AMBROSE VIDEO PUBLISHING 1995

DESCRIPTION

In 1532, Francisco Pizarro and a band of 170 conquistadors, searching for gold, embarked on the conquest of the Incan empire. Though badly outnumbered, they kidnapped Atahualpa, the god-king, and held him captive for nine months before murdering him. Reenactments and graphics help describe Incan civilization and its destruction.

ACADEMIC STANDARDS

Subject Area: World History

- ◆ Standard: Understands major global trends from 1000 to 1500 CE
 - Benchmark: Understands differences and similarities between the Inca and Aztec empires and empires of Afro-Eurasia (e.g., political institutions, warfare, social organizations, cultural achievements)
- ◆ Standard: Understands how the transoceanic interlinking of all major regions of the world between 1450 and 1600 led to global transformations
 - Benchmark: Understands features of Spanish exploration and conquest (e.g., why the Spanish wanted to invade the Incan and Aztec empires, and why these empires collapsed after the conflict with the Spanish; interaction between the Spanish and indigenous populations such as the Inca and the Aztec; different perspectives on Cortes' journey into Mexico)
 - Benchmark: Understands cultural interaction between various societies in the late 15th and 16th centuries (e.g., how the Church helped administer Spanish and Portuguese colonies in the Americas; reasons for the fall of the Incan empire to Pizarro; how the Portuguese dominated seaborne trade in the Indian Ocean basin in the 16th century; the relations between pilgrims and indigenous populations in North and South America, and the role different religious sects played in these relations; how the presence of Spanish conquerors affected the daily lives of Aztec, Maya, and Inca peoples)

INSTRUCTIONAL GOALS

1. To present the features of Spanish exploration and conquest.
2. To depict the advanced culture of the Incas.
3. To review the events that led up to the Spanish defeating the Incas.

VOCABULARY

1. conquistador
2. intrepid
3. slaughter
4. usurper
5. captivity
6. ransom
7. garroting
8. ingot
9. elite
10. expeditionary



BEFORE SHOWING

1. Discuss the Cortes and Spanish conquest of the Aztecs in Mexico.
2. Locate the following places on a map of the world.
 - a. Spain: Estremadura
 - b. Mexico
 - c. South America
 - (1) The Andes Mountains
 - (2) Peru
 - (3) Quito
 - (4) Cuzco
 - (5) Jauja
 - (6) Cajamarca
 - (7) Machu Picchu



AFTER SHOWING

Discussion Items and Questions

1. Discuss Francisco Pizarro and the Spanish conquistadors.
 - a. Why were the conquistadors the most feared warriors of all time?
 - b. In what ways may Pizarro's illegitimacy and illiteracy influenced him? What stigma may have been attached with these traits?
 - c. How was Pizarro inspired by Cortes?
 - d. Based on what criteria did Pizarro hand-pick his men?
 - e. What was the definition of a good Spaniard?
 - f. How did Pizarro fail to assign the blame to the Incas for the death and destruction of the Inca people?
 - g. In what ways was Pizarro an upstart commoner?
 - h. What was King Charles V's response to Pizarro's trial and execution of Atahualpa?
2. Discuss the Incas.

- a. What did the Incas value?
 - b. What features of Inca society were surprising and striking to the Spanish?
 - c. Why did the Spaniards' horses strike fear into the hearts of the Incas?
 - d. In what ways was the Inca civilization young in 1530 when Pizarro arrived?
 - e. How were the Incas themselves conquerors?
 - f. What did Inca buildings and towns demonstrate about their culture?
 - g. How did other Andean tribes perceive Atahualpa and the Incas?
 - h. Why did some local tribes opt to side with the Spaniards?
 - i. In what ways was Inca society similar to communism? To ancient Egyptian society?
 - j. How might life have differed for the Inca elite and the commoner?
 - k. What was the Incas' great wealth from their perspective? From the Spaniards' perspective?
 - l. In what ways did the Incas' system of communication resemble the Pony Express?
3. Discuss Atahualpa.
- a. How did Atahualpa come to power?
 - b. How did he handle the unrest of his people?
 - c. Why and how did Atahualpa run his massive empire from captivity?
 - d. What Spanish traps did he fall into?
 - e. What led to his death?
 - f. Why did he embrace Catholicism?
4. Discuss the conquest of the Incas.
- a. How did 170 Spanish soldiers and adventurers defeat a civilization of millions of people?
 - b. Why did the Inca people not immediately seize this small band of Spaniards?
 - c. How did the Incas' religious beliefs aid the Spaniards in their conquest?
 - d. What factors in the Incas' political situation worked to the conquistadors' advantage?
 - e. What role did smallpox play in the Spaniards' victory?
 - f. Why were the Spaniards filled with fear and confusion when they reached the Inca town of Cajamarca?
 - g. Why did the Incas' underestimating the Spaniards' power prove to be a fatal mistake?
 - h. How did the Spaniards' plan to kidnap Atahualpa and Atahualpa's plan to consolidate his victory in the civil war initially work hand in hand?
 - i. How did the Inca and Spanish people communicate?
 - j. What were the Incas' losses in their interaction with the Spaniards?
 - k. How would history and the world be different if the Incas had banded together and routed the Spaniards?



5. Compare the character and misconceptions of Atahualpa and Pizarro based on the following speeches.
 - a. Pizarro: "I ...shall subject you to the yoke and obedience of the Church and His Majesty... the deaths and destruction that come from this will be your fault."
 - b. Atahualpa: "Who are these people? They are rude and dirty. They boast, and treat our people badly. They eat silver and gold. They have no fine clothes. We have no need to fear them."



Applications and Activities

1. Research the initial discovery of the Incas by Europeans.
 - a. Which European country first found the Incas?
 - b. What was their response?
 - c. In what year did this happen?
2. Investigate the Moorish invasions of Spain.
 - a. In what ways were the Moors invading Spain similar to the Spanish invading the Incas?
 - b. How did these conflicts between the Moors and the Spanish influence and train the conquistadors?
3. Compare the Inca civilization to other ancient peoples. Consider the Romans, the Spartans, the Knights Templar, the Macedonians, the Aztecs, the Huns, the Assyrians and the Janissaries. Include comparisons of the following:
 - a. architecture
 - b. social hierarchy and values
 - c. government and politics
 - d. religious beliefs
 - e. economy and business
4. Reenact Pizarro hand-picking his men.
Consider including resumes, interviews, tests and recommendations to determine if a person may join the conquistadors' quest.
5. Investigate armor and tools that the conquistadors may have used. Include swords, lances, armor and horses.
6. Research smallpox.
 - a. What are the symptoms of the disease?
 - b. Why is this disease nearly unheard of in modern times?
 - c. Why did the disease wreck havoc on indigenous peoples?
 - d. What restrictions and rules are in place to prevent the spread of diseases?
7. Imagine if the Incas had not been defeated by the Spaniards.
 - a. What success may the Incas have had in invading Spain?
 - b. How would schools in the Americas be different?
 - c. What language and religious beliefs might have become the standard in the Americas?



RELATED RESOURCES



Captioned Media Program

- The Assyrians #3565
- The Aztecs #3567
- Europe Explores the Americas: Southern Voyages and Settlements #3356
- The Huns #3618
- The Janissaries #3621
- The Knights Templar #3623
- The Macedonians #3633
- Peru: Kingdom in the Clouds #3498
- The Romans #3652
- The Spartans #3664

World Wide Web



The following Web sites complement the contents of this guide; they were selected by professionals who have experience in teaching deaf and hard of hearing students. Every effort was made to select accurate, educationally relevant, and "kid-safe" sites. However, teachers should preview them before use. The U.S. Department of Education, the National Association of the Deaf, and the Captioned Media Program do not endorse the sites and are not responsible for their content.

- **THE CIVILIZATION OF THE INCAS**

http://www.best.com/~swanson/inca/eg_inca_menu1.html

Includes an overview of Inca civilization including links to other related sites.

- **THE CULTURE OF THE ANDES**

<http://www.andes.org/>

This site includes Quechuan language lessons, music, songs, poems, stories and resources in Quechua, Spanish, and English.

- **THE ART AND CULTURE OF THE INCAS**

<http://www.theincas.com/>

A pictorial tribute to the pottery, goldwork, and masonry of the Incas. Includes a history of Ecuador and links.

- **ANDES EXPEDITION: SEARCHING FOR INCA SECRETS**

<http://www.nationalgeographic.com/features/97/andes/>

This National Geographic site offers a diary of the expedition to the Andes and a virtual autopsy of a frozen mummy found during the expedition. Great photographs enhance this site.